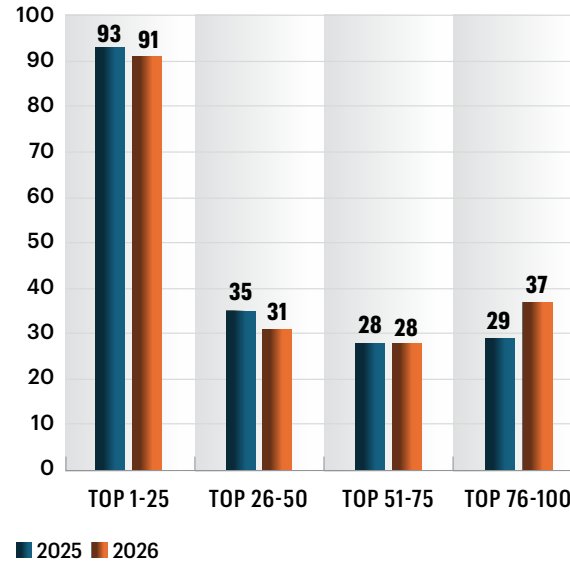


THE JOB OFFERS

• Average pre-placement offers declined from 93 to 91 in the Top 1–25 and from 35 to 31 in the Top 26–50



SOURCE BT-MDRA BEST B-SCHOOLS SURVEY 2026-27

enue generation, people analytics, GCC strategy and operations optimisation.

At K J Somaiya, BFSI remains one of the strongest recruiters, but even here roles are becoming more technology-led. Product management and business analysis roles are emerging as financial institutions try to bridge traditional banking and fintech.

At the entry level, Chatterjee says AI is redefining roles around judgement, problem framing, stakeholder management and the ability to act on insights as routine analysis and reporting become increasingly automated.

The MBA is not disappearing in the AI era. But the graduate who can connect technology to a business outcome has an advantage over one whose strongest credential is simply completing a management programme.

Puneet Kumra, Vice President, Talent Acquisition–India, Capgemini, describes the market as a "selective recovery", with greater scrutiny around capability, timing and long-term relevance.

The improvement in placements, he says, should not be mistaken for a return to the hiring environment of a few years ago. "Companies are hiring where they have a clear business need and are concentrating on institutions and talent pools where they see stronger alignment with those needs."

THE EMPLOYER NOW HAS TO SELL TOO

As Gen Z enters the workforce, campus recruitment is becoming a two-way pitch. Companies are not only selecting candidates; they are also having to persuade them that the organisation, role and workplace are worth choosing.

K J Somaiya's Chopra says some progressive organisations are moving away from assumptions about Gen Z and instead adapting how they engage with the generation. Recruiters are spending entire days on campus, holding conclaves and explaining their organisations, sectors, roles and workplace culture.

For B-schools, the challenge is shifting from placement outcomes to employability itself: building students who are ready to create value before the final placement process even begins.

Students who can acquire those capabilities can fetch a premium, even as the rules for earning that premium keeps changing. BT